

king, by writ of Privy Seal, signified that he "gave and forgave him his life," but ordered his body to be remitted to prison.¹ The record and process were afterwards laid before the parliament, which confirmed the judgment.² Coke says, that Sir William Thorpe was pardoned and restored to all his lands, "as by the record appeareth;"³ but the record, as published, only says that the execution of the judgment of hanging was pardoned to him, and that he was remitted to prison to await the king's favour. The remainder of the judgment, "that all his lands and goods should be forfeited to the king," is left unnoticed, and consequently unpardoned; and by entries on the records of that year⁴, it appears that the sheriffs of Lincoln and other counties were directed to take his lands, &c., into the king's hands, as convicted of certain crimes; and that four of his horses, "*cum cellis frenis et garconibus*," were seized by one of the sheriffs of London.

In the following year, however, he received the king's pardon, with the restoration of part of his lands; viz., the manor of Changton, in Sussex.⁵ He was not restored to his office of chief justice, which William de Shreshull certainly held during the next five years; but after an interval of eighteen months he was made second baron of the Exchequer, on May 24, 1352, 26 Edward III.; unless the William de Thorpe who then received that appointment was a different person. In the absence of any evidence to the contrary, there is good reason to believe that he was the same person; the more especially as we have instances, ten years before, of the king's reinstating judges against whom charges had been made; and as it was extremely improbable that a person, of whom no previous notice exists of his being

¹ N. Fœdera, iii. 203.² Rot. Parl. ii. 227.³ Third Inst. 145.⁴ Abbrev. Rot. Orig. ii. 211, 212.⁵ Cal. Rot. Pat. 160.